

## 20

## Web Browser, Intranet and Web Application Problems

Browser errors, certificate warnings, blocked sites, SSO loops and cache issues

**Default priority:** P3 Medium  
(P2 if a company-wide web service is affected)**Target response / resolution:** Respond in 15 min / resolve in 2 business hours**Handled by:** Tier 1, then Tier 2 / Web team

### Scope

Use this instruction when a user cannot open or use a website, an intranet page, or a web application in the browser, or sees certificate, sign-in, or loading errors.

**Related instructions:** WI-10 Security Incidents, WI-06 Network, WI-14 Business Applications

### Common symptoms

- Page will not load or times out
- Certificate or 'connection is not private' warning
- Endless sign-in loop with single sign-on
- Page layout broken or buttons do nothing
- A site is blocked by the web filter

### Information to collect

- The full address (URL) and the exact error message
- Browser and version, and whether other browsers show the same
- Whether it works on another device, network, or for another user
- When it last worked, and any recent change

### Resolution steps

- 1 Check the service.** Test the site from your own device and check the status page. If the site is down for everyone, link to the incident and update the user.
- 2 Test another browser.** Try the site in a second browser and in a private window. This separates a browser fault from an account or site fault.
- 3 Clear cache and cookies.** Clear the cached files and cookies for the site, restart the browser, and try again. Disable extensions and test.
- 4 Check date, time and certificate.** Check the device date and time are right, and read the certificate warning. A wrong clock or an untrusted certificate is a common cause. Do not tell users to bypass real warnings.
- 5 Check sign-in and policies.** For sign-in loops, clear cookies, check the account and MFA status, and test with another browser profile. Check for conflicting accounts signed in at the same time.
- 6 Check the web filter and network.** If the site is blocked, check the category and the business need. Request an unblock through the approved process rather than disabling the filter. Test on another network.
- 7 Update or reset the browser.** Update the browser to the current version, reset it to defaults if needed, and confirm that the user's bookmarks and passwords are synced first.

#### Escalate when

- Certificate errors on internal or company sites affecting many users
- Suspected malicious site, redirect, or browser hijack (see WI-10)
- Web filter change requests that need Security approval

#### Resolution and closure

- Record the cause (cache, extension, certificate, filter, site fault) and the fix
- Add a knowledge article for repeated issues
- Close after the user confirms the site works

## Quick troubleshooting reference

| Symptom                                 | Likely cause                                      | What to do                                                                              |
|-----------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>'Your connection is not private'</b> | Wrong clock, expired certificate, or interception | Check the date and time, then the certificate. Escalate if it affects an internal site. |
| <b>Page loads but is broken</b>         | Old cache or extension conflict                   | Clear the cache, disable extensions, and try a private window.                          |
| <b>Sign-in loop</b>                     | Stale cookies or multiple accounts                | Clear cookies, sign out of all accounts, and sign in with the work account only.        |
| <b>Site blocked</b>                     | Web filter category                               | Check the business need and submit an unblock request for review.                       |
| <b>Site works on another browser</b>    | Browser profile or extension fault                | Create a new profile, or reset the browser.                                             |

## Suggested wording for the user

|               |                                                                                                                                           |
|---------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Open</b>   | <i>"Could you tell me the exact address you are visiting and what you see on the screen?"</i>                                             |
| <b>During</b> | <i>"I am going to ask you to try a private window. This will tell us if it is something saved in your browser."</i>                       |
| <b>Close</b>  | <i>"The page is loading properly now. If you see a security warning on any site, please do not click through it and call us instead."</i> |

## Good practice

### Do

- Ask for the exact address and message
- Test in a second browser
- Treat certificate warnings seriously
- Check for extensions and cache

### Do not

- Do not tell users to ignore certificate warnings
- Do not disable the web filter or security tools to test
- Do not install unapproved browser extensions
- Do not clear all browser data without warning the user

## Worked example

Several users get a certificate warning on the company intranet after the weekend.

| Ticket note field       | Entry                                                                         |
|-------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Issue reported</b>   | Intranet shows 'Your connection is not private' for multiple users.           |
| <b>Checks performed</b> | Certificate expired at midnight on Saturday.                                  |
| <b>Cause</b>            | Certificate not renewed in time.                                              |
| <b>Action taken</b>     | Escalated as a P2 to the Web team, who renewed and installed the certificate. |
| <b>Result</b>           | Warning cleared. Added the certificate to the expiry monitoring list.         |

## Analyst checklist

- |                                                           |                                                                            |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Check the service                | <input type="checkbox"/> Check the web filter and network                  |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Test another browser             | <input type="checkbox"/> Update or reset the browser                       |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Clear cache and cookies          | <input type="checkbox"/> Ticket note completed using the standard template |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Check date, time and certificate | <input type="checkbox"/> User confirmed the issue is resolved              |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Check sign-in and policies       |                                                                            |

## Preventing repeat tickets

- Monitor certificate expiry dates
- Keep browsers updated through policy
- Standardize on approved browsers and extensions
- Publish a guide on identifying fake sites